13 June 2023

Mr Marcio Amaral Dos Anjos Sousa
Unit 904, 101 St Kilda Road
ST KILDA VIC 3182

To Whom It May Concern

Re: **Mr Marcio Amaral Dos Anjos Sousa** **UR: 039762**
Unit 904, 101 St Kilda Road
ST KILDA VIC 3182 **DOB: 26/11/1981**
Phone: 0405 455 474

I write to confirm that Mr Amaral Dos Anjos Sousa is a patient under the care of Calvary Bethlehem Hospital with a diagnosis of **truncal onset Motor Neurone Disease (MND)** which first emerged at the end of 2019. He was initially referred to this service by Dr Mahi Jasinarachchi, consultant neurologist at Neurology Network, on 19 November 2021. He was then initially reviewed by Dr Laura Perju-Dumbrava before being transferred to my care on 4 October 2022. As you are aware, MND is a progressive neurodegenerative condition. There is no treatment to stop or reverse disease progression. It is universally life altering and fatal. There is one oral treatment which slows down disease progression, riluzole, but Mr Amaral Dos Anjos Sousa was unable to tolerate this medication due to side effects. He is currently not on any disease modifying treatment.

Mr Sousa is a lovely 41 year old left handed IT professional. At the end of 2019, he and his wife noted fasciculations in his arms. During 2020, this progressed to weakness. Currently he has weakness in all four limbs, although it does not affect his ability to perform personal activities of daily living. He can still stand and walk short distances. They have self-funded an electric wheelchair which he uses for longer outings.

His main issue currently is with regards to his truncal/core weakness. He finds his poor posture sitting difficult. This also causes him to fatigue when he walks. Leg strength and respiratory function do not limit him when he walks.

The Motor Neurone Disease has not stopped him from working full-time in his usual job as an IT professional.

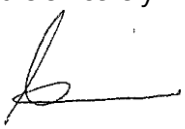
Otherwise his past medical history is only relevant for some depression which is longstanding likely up to 10 years in duration. This is treated very well which a stable dose of escitalopram.

Lung function test was performed in May 2023. Forced vital capacity was 71% and SNIP 31% compared with 74% and 33% respectively in Jan 2023. Hence his disease is ***not*** progressing rapidly.

Furthermore, with the regular use of non-invasive ventilation and gastrostomy tube generally in the MND cohort, prognosis of MND has improved. Hence, at this point, I would estimate Mr Amaral Dos Anjos Sousa's to be about 2-3 years.

With kind regards

Yours sincerely



Dr Sarah Lee
Consultant Neurologist

SL:jc

Cc: Dr Adele Knights
Bayside Medical Group – Hampton
3 Service Street
HAMPTON VIC 3188

Cc: Dr Laura Perju-Dumbrava
Neurologist
Calvary HealthCare Bethlehem

Cc: Dr Mahi Jasinarachchi
Neurology Network Melbourne
Suite 3, Level 1
517 St Kilda Road
MELBOURNE VIC 3004